

# LADDER SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Control fall, slip and overturn hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

## OBJECTIVE

Ensure the safe use of portable and fixed ladders while preventing falls, slips, overturning and misuse.

## TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Use ladders only for short-duration, low-risk work.
- Inspect ladders before use and remove damaged ladders from service.
- Apply the 4:1 rule, maintain three points of contact and position the ladder on stable ground.

## REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker overreached while standing on the top step of a ladder.
- The ladder slipped and the worker fell.
- Correct positioning and repositioning the ladder would have prevented the incident.

## REMEMBER

A ladder provides access, not a work platform.

# LADDER SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, safe use and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

## KEY HAZARDS

- Damaged ladders
- Incorrect angle
- Unstable ground
- Standing on the top step
- Overreaching
- Metal ladders near electricity
- Unsecured ladders
- Carrying loads while climbing

## CONTROL MEASURES

- Inspect before use.
- Apply the 4:1 rule.
- Maintain three points of contact.
- Secure the ladder.
- Do not stand on the top step.
- Reposition instead of overreaching.
- Use fiberglass ladders near electricity.
- Check anti-slip feet.
- Remove damaged ladders from service.
- Barricade the area if necessary.

## SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Today all ladders will be inspected before use. We will apply the 4:1 rule, maintain three points of contact and never work from the top step.

## DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Has the ladder been inspected?
- Is the 4:1 rule applied?
- Is the ladder secured?
- Is the ground stable?
- Is there an electrical hazard?
- Will three points of contact be maintained?

## VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- |                                                     |                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Ladder inspected           | <input type="checkbox"/> Rungs intact        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Anti-slip feet OK          | <input type="checkbox"/> Correct angle       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Ladder secured             | <input type="checkbox"/> Ground stable       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Electrical hazard assessed | <input type="checkbox"/> Three-point contact |
| <input type="checkbox"/> PPE worn                   | <input type="checkbox"/> Team briefed        |

# ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

## LADDER SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

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Date

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Presented by

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Work area

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| No | Full Name | Company / Role | Signature |
|----|-----------|----------------|-----------|
| 1  |           |                |           |
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| 14 |           |                |           |

Supervisor notes